Iteration K2: Storing Support Requests from Our Mailbox

As we mentioned above, the purpose of mailboxes is to allow us to execute code on every email we receive. Because emails come in whenever the sender sends them, we'll need to store the details of a customer support request somewhere for an administrator to handle later. To that end, we'll create a new model called `SupportRequest` that will hold the relevant details of the request, and have the `process` method of `SupportMailbox` create an instance for each email we get (in the final section of this chapter, we'll display these in a UI so an admin can respond).

Creating a Model for Support Requests

We want our model to hold the sender's email, the subject and body of the email, and a reference to the customer's most recent order if there's one on file. First, let's create the model using a Rails generator:

```
> bin/rails generate model support_request
      invoke  active_record
      create    db/migrate/20250420000014_create_support_requests.rb
      create    app/models/support_request.rb
      invoke    test_unit
      create      test/models/support_request_test.rb
      create      test/fixtures/support_requests.yml
```

This created a migration for us, which is currently empty (remember that migration filenames have a date and time in them, so your filename will be slightly different). Let's fill that in.

rails80/depot_tb/db/migrate/20250420000014_create_support_requests.rb

```
class CreateSupportRequests < ActiveRecord::Migration[8.0]
  def change
    create_table :support_requests do |t|
»     t.string :email, comment: "Email of the submitter"
```